DIGITAL LITERACY PROJECT

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COURSE: COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING

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INTRODUCTION:

This project report presents the work completed as part of the Digital Literacy course, focusing on the development of essential skills required for effective participation in the digital world. It covers a range of activities designed to build competence in using online tools, understanding digital platforms, and communicating appropriately in academic and professional settings.

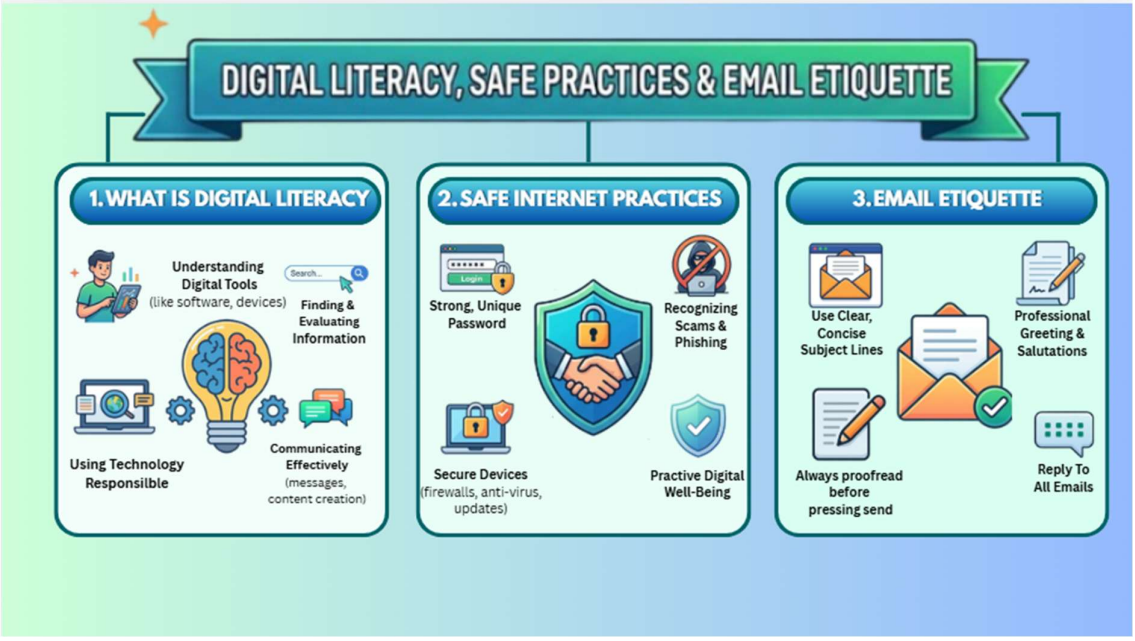
The report includes tasks related to creating digital content, exploring coding and collaboration platforms, practicing formal communication, and understanding online safety and cyber awareness. Each section highlights the practical application of these skills and reflects the learning outcomes achieved through the activities. Overall, the project emphasizes the importance of being digitally aware, responsible, and efficient while using technology for academic purposes.

TASK 1	Create a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For my project, I created an infographic using Canva. It focuses on digital literacy and explains its key aspects, such as understanding how to use digital tools, practicing safe internet habits, and following proper email etiquette. I organized the content into clear sections so that it is easy to read and visually appealing. The design highlights that digital literacy is not just about how to use computers and smartphones, but also about how to use them responsibly, such as creating strong passwords, avoiding scams, and writing professional emails.

While working on the infographic, I found it challenging to arrange all the information in a way that looked neat without appearing too cluttered. I had to carefully choose colours, fonts, and a layout that worked well together, since an infographic should be both attractive and easy to understand. However, this process was also interesting and enjoyable. Canva provided a variety of tools and templates that allowed me to experiment with different styles and ideas. Overall, creating this infographic was a valuable learning experience that helped me improve my design skills and deepen my understanding of digital literacy.

INFOGRAPHIC:



TASK 2	Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

For my project, I chose to use LinkedIn, Kaggle, and GitHub as my primary platforms for professional and technical growth. LinkedIn is mainly used for building a professional network, showcasing achievements, and staying updated with industry trends. I plan to regularly update my profile, connect with professionals, and share my learning progress over the next four years.

Kaggle is a platform focused on data science and machine learning. It allows users to work on real-world datasets, participate in competitions, and improve analytical skills. I intend to use Kaggle to practice data analysis, learn new techniques, and build a strong portfolio in data science.

GitHub is used for version control and sharing code. It helps in collaborating on projects and maintaining a record of my work. Over the next four years, I plan to consistently upload my projects, contribute to open-source, and improve my coding skills through real-world applications.

Together, these platforms will help me build a strong professional profile, enhance my technical skills, and prepare me for future career opportunities.

TASK 3	Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

For my project, I used HackerRank and Google Forms as my primary platforms. On HackerRank, I practiced coding problems that helped me improve my logical thinking, problem-solving skills, and understanding of programming concepts. It allowed me to work on real-world challenges and enhance my confidence in writing efficient code.

Using Google Forms, I created a digital literacy awareness quiz. The quiz was designed to test knowledge about safe internet usage, digital tools, and basic online communication practices. I structured the form with clear questions and options, making it user-friendly and easy to understand.

These tools will greatly help me academically. HackerRank strengthens my coding abilities, which are essential for my computer science studies and future exams. Google Forms helps me learn how to present information clearly and collect responses efficiently, which is useful for projects, surveys, and research work. Overall, both platforms have improved my technical and practical skills.

TASK 4	Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

A situation where poor digital communication caused a problem can be seen in a group project scenario. One team member sent a short and unclear message in the group chat saying, “I’ll handle the report,” without specifying which part or by when. Other members assumed different things, leading to confusion and duplication of work. As a result, some sections were repeated while others were left incomplete, affecting the overall quality and submission timing.

This issue could have been avoided with clear and detailed communication. The student should have specified the exact sections they would handle, set deadlines, and confirmed responsibilities with the group. Additionally, regular updates and proper coordination using structured messages or shared documents would have ensured everyone stayed aligned and avoided misunderstandings.

5 Do's and 5 Don'ts for responsible social media use as a college student

DO's	DON'Ts
▫ Think before you post—ensure your content is respectful and appropriate. ▫ Maintain privacy settings to protect your personal information. ▫ Use social media for learning, networking, and sharing useful content. ▫ Verify information before sharing to avoid spreading misinformation. ▫ Be respectful and professional in comments, messages, and posts.	▫ Don't share sensitive personal details like address, phone number, or passwords. ▫ Don't engage in online arguments or toxic discussions. ▫ Don't post inappropriate, offensive, or harmful content. ▫ Don't waste excessive time scrolling—balance academics and social media use. ▫ Don't plagiarize or use others' content without giving proper credit.

TASK 5	Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

What surprised me most while researching cybercrime was how easily people can be tricked through simple methods like phishing emails or fake payment requests. I always assumed such scams were obvious, but many of them are designed to look very genuine, using official logos, urgent messages, and familiar names. This made me realize that even careful users can make mistakes if they act quickly without verifying.

One habit I will personally change is being more cautious before clicking on links or responding to messages. I will make it a rule to always verify the source, especially for emails or texts that ask for personal or financial information. By slowing down and double-checking, I can reduce the chances of falling victim to cyber fraud and protect my personal data more effectively.

CONCLUSION:

This project focuses on developing essential digital literacy skills required in today's academic environment. Through a series of structured tasks, it helped strengthen my ability to use digital tools effectively, communicate in a clear and professional manner, and approach online platforms with awareness and responsibility. I also improved my problem-solving skills by engaging with practical activities and applying concepts in real-world scenarios.

Additionally, the project enhanced my understanding of safe online practices and the importance of maintaining a responsible digital presence. It encouraged me to think critically, organize information clearly, and present my work in a structured format. Overall, this experience has helped me become more confident in using technology for academic purposes and better prepared to handle digital tasks efficiently and responsibly.